

# CLASS ATTENDANCE POLICY

## Purpose:

The academic goals and achievements of individual students are the University's primary purpose. The University also recognizes the significant contribution of other activities to the academic and personal development of Bucknell students. It is inevitable that conflicts will arise between the pursuit of extracurricular activities and students' academic schedules. It is desirable, when conflicts do occur, that students have a policy available to guide their decisions concerning class attendance. This policy states the expectations placed on faculty members, students, and extracurricular advisers, so that students may know their options and the ramifications of their choices. In addition, faculty are strongly encouraged to include a statement about their individual expectations for class attendance in course syllabi.

## Scope:

This policy applies to all faculty, extracurricular advisers and currently enrolled students.

## Policy:

### A. Responsibilities about class attendance:

1. Students are expected to attend the regularly scheduled meetings of the courses in which they are enrolled.
2. Classes meeting during their officially scheduled class hours should be given priority over other activities, including activities from other classes. "No student who participates in an extracurricular event, team or program can be penalized solely for missing such extracurricular activities when they are scheduled in conflict with regularly scheduled meeting times of the student's courses." (Action of the faculty, October 1993)
3. Faculty should provide, on the first day of classes, a clear statement of:
  - a. The consequences of any absences.
  - b. Requested time commitments outside of class.
4. Students should not be required to attend extra, additional or rescheduled academic events that conflict with other classes or other important commitments that occur outside of registered meeting times for their classes unless those events are clearly described in the course schedule prior to registration.
5. As a residential institution it is expected that students attend classes and be in residence while enrolled in courses during the semester or summer session. If a student is unable to attend all classes for more than two weeks in a row (1 week during the summer session), they are advised to contact their academic associate dean to discuss possible options, such as academic flexibility for course work, incomplete grades for course work, withdrawal from an individual course, or leave of absence.

(personal or health-related) from the semester or summer session. The options available may be affected by the timing during the semester and the pedagogy or requirements for a course. Once final grades are submitted, students will not be permitted to retroactively withdraw from a course or the semester regardless of the reason. *In cases where students are not responsive to outreach from their academic associate dean's office, an administrative leave of absence may be initiated based on lack of attendance.*

B. Responsibilities about non-class activities:

1. Extracurricular advisers should, during the first week of classes, inform students of those dates upon which they will be asked to miss a class due to an extracurricular activity.
2. Students should give faculty as much advanced warning of a class absence as possible.
3. University units regularly sponsoring extracurricular activities are urged to develop guidelines about the appropriate level of demands to place upon student participants with respect to missing class.
4. The consequences of missing class, regardless of reason, remain at the discretion of the faculty member teaching the class, as articulated in their syllabus (see A.3).

C. General responsibilities:

1. Because students are ultimately responsible for their education at Bucknell University, they must be the ones to weigh the consequences of missing classes or other activities and make their choices accordingly.
2. Both faculty and advisers of extracurricular activities must provide the information students will need to make informed decisions. All parties are encouraged to communicate and to be as flexible as possible in addressing schedule conflicts.
3. Students, faculty and extracurricular advisers may seek advice in these matters from their college dean or provost.